



TRIDENT COLLEGE

AI STRATEGIC PROJECT PLAN

2026-2029

From AI adoption to an AI-enabled, human-centred school

Strategic direction, implementation roadmap, action plan, governance and measures of success

OUR NORTH STAR

AI should make the people at Trident more capable, not less important.

Prepared for strategic discussion and Board oversight | August 2026

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Document Purpose

This document converts Trident College's AI vision into an executable three-year strategic project. It is designed to be used simultaneously as a Board strategy paper, an implementation roadmap and a live project-management reference. It identifies the workstreams, concrete actions, proposed ownership, timing, deliverables, success measures and decision gates required to move from responsible experimentation to an embedded AI-enabled school.

Item	Proposed position
Strategic period	August 2026 - June 2029
Initial implementation phase	August - December 2026
Project sponsor	Head of College
Operational governance	Proposed AI Steering Group reporting through the Senior Leadership Team
Board oversight	Termly progress summary; annual strategy review
Document status	Strategic project plan - roles, dates and budgets to be confirmed through governance

How to read this plan

- Sections 1-8 set out the strategic logic, governance, priorities and success criteria.
- Section 9 is the master implementation matrix. It is deliberately detailed and should become the live action tracker for the project.
- The “Proposed lead” column assigns accountability by role rather than by individual name, allowing the plan to remain useful through staffing changes.
- The “Timing” column uses realistic implementation windows beginning in August 2026. Scaling is conditional on evidence, safeguarding, data protection and the Trident LTCES Framework, a decision framework developed by Trident College.
- The “Status / RAG” column is intentionally left as a project-control field and can be updated at each Steering Group or SLT review.

1 Strategic Intent

What Trident is trying to achieve - and what it is not trying to achieve.

Trident's aim is not to become the school that uses the greatest number of AI tools. The aim is to become a school that uses AI intelligently, selectively and safely to improve the quality of learning, teaching, leadership and school operations while deliberately protecting the human relationships, judgement, character and community at the heart of the College.

STRATEGIC PROPOSITION

AI is an enabling layer across the school, not a separate technology project. Every initiative must begin with an educational or organisational problem worth solving.

The project will pursue five strategic outcomes

- Learning: more responsive, personalised and intellectually demanding learning, with students remaining active thinkers rather than passive recipients of generated answers.
- Teachers: lower avoidable workload, stronger planning and assessment, and faster access to curriculum information and insight - including syllabus requirements, curriculum sequencing, student misconceptions, assessment evidence and appropriate teaching resources - giving teachers more time for relationships, feedback and professional judgement.
- Leadership and operations: faster access to relevant school information, reduced duplication, better analysis and more efficient routine processes.
- Community: clearer access to school information and improved support for students, staff, parents, admissions and governance.
- Human development and ethics: students and staff who understand AI capability, limitations, bias, privacy, verification, authorship and responsible use.

Non-goals

- Replacing teachers, counsellors, leaders or safeguarding professionals with automated decision-making.
- Deploying student-facing AI simply because it is novel or commercially attractive.
- Uploading confidential or sensitive school information into unapproved public AI services.
- Using AI to make unsupervised high-stakes decisions about safeguarding, discipline, admissions, staff performance, wellbeing or medical matters.
- Treating AI detection software as a substitute for sound assessment design and professional judgement.

2 Project Design Principles

Principle	Operational meaning
Human first	AI supports human judgement; accountability remains with people.
Educational purpose	Every deployment must solve a defined learning, teaching or organisational problem.
Transparency	People should know when AI is used and what role it has played.
Privacy and safeguarding	Data classification, age appropriateness and safeguarding requirements precede convenience.
Academic integrity	Assessment must continue to reveal what a student knows, can do and can explain.
Equity	AI should widen access and capability, not create a new divide between confident and less-confident users.
Evidence before expansion	Pilots are measured before school-wide adoption.
Capability, not dependency	AI use should strengthen thinking, expertise and agency rather than weaken them.

The Trident LTCES Framework - developed by Trident College

Trident College has developed the LTCES Framework as a practical internal decision tool to ensure that every significant AI initiative is educationally worthwhile, supportive of people, appropriate for the community, ethically responsible and sustainable. Before a material AI initiative is approved, the Steering Group should explicitly test it against the five dimensions below. Failure against the ethical or safeguarding dimension should stop the initiative; weakness in any other dimension should trigger redesign before scale.

Test	Approval question
L - Learning	Does it improve learning, educational quality or a clearly defined school outcome?
T - Teachers	Does it empower staff and strengthen professional practice rather than add friction or dependency?
C - Community	Does it benefit the wider Trident community and fit its needs and values?
E - Ethical	Is it safe, fair, transparent, age-appropriate and responsible?
S - Sustainable	Is it secure, affordable, scalable, supportable and future-ready?

3 Governance and Accountability

The main risk in AI implementation is not lack of experimentation; it is uncoordinated experimentation. Trident therefore needs lightweight but explicit governance that allows innovation while maintaining institutional control over data, safeguarding, assessment and cost.

Role	Core accountability
Board /TCC	Endorse strategy; scrutinise risk, impact and investment; receive termly dashboard and annual strategy review.
Head of College - Project Sponsor	Own strategic direction; chair or sponsor major decision gates; ensure AI remains aligned to the College mission and school priorities.
AI Steering Group	Coordinate workstreams; approve pilots; apply the Trident LTCES Framework (developed by Trident College); maintain risk and action logs; recommend scaling or closure.
Senior Leadership Team	Integrate AI priorities into academic, pastoral, boarding, HR, admissions and operational plans; remove organisational barriers.
IT / Data Protection Lead	Maintain approved-platform list, access controls, data classification, vendor/security review, technical architecture and incident response.
Academic Leadership / Heads of Department	Lead pedagogy, curriculum, assessment redesign and discipline-specific expectations.
Safeguarding Lead	Review age-appropriate use, wellbeing, harmful content, reporting routes and safeguarding implications.
AI Champions	Test practice, model responsible use, support colleagues, capture examples and feed implementation evidence to the Steering Group.
All staff	Use approved systems, protect data, disclose material AI use where required and retain responsibility for professional outputs and decisions.
Students	Follow age-appropriate acceptable-use and academic-integrity expectations; disclose AI assistance where required; verify outputs.

Proposed governance rhythm

Cadence	Purpose
Monthly - implementation	AI Steering Group reviews action tracker, risks, pilot evidence, support needs and new requests.
Half-term	SLT reviews key decisions, resource implications and unresolved cross-school issues.
Termly	Board receives concise dashboard: progress, risks, staff/student capability, pilots, data incidents, cost and impact evidence.
Annually	Formal strategy refresh incorporating technology changes, educational evidence, policy developments and Trident outcomes.

4 Technology and AI Ecosystem

Trident should favour a controlled ecosystem over a proliferation of disconnected consumer tools. The existing Microsoft 365 environment should form the default identity, document, collaboration and permissions layer wherever practical, supplemented only by approved tools that meet educational, privacy, safeguarding, integration and value requirements.

Target architecture

- Identity and access: school-managed accounts, role-based permissions and appropriate age controls.
- Approved AI layer: secure institutional AI tools rather than unmanaged personal accounts for school data.
- Knowledge layer: curated policies, curriculum resources, handbooks, templates and approved internal information with clear ownership and version control.
- Agent layer: specialised assistants for defined tasks, each constrained to approved information, prompts, workflows and permissions.
- Human oversight: no autonomous high-stakes decision-making; professional review remains explicit.
- Monitoring layer: adoption, incidents, costs, feedback, performance and quality measures.

Initial agent portfolio - sequenced by value and risk

Priority	Agent / capability	Primary user	Risk	Purpose / constraint
1	Trident Policy / Knowledge Assistant	Staff	Low-medium	Quick access to approved policies and procedures; useful early proof of secure retrieval and governance.
2	Teacher Planning / Curriculum Coach	Staff	Medium	Planning, sequencing, differentiation, questioning and resource support anchored to Trident curriculum expectations.
3	Assessment Coach	Staff	Medium	Assessment design, moderation support, question quality, rubrics and analysis - with teacher approval.
4	Leadership Assistant / Dashboard	Leaders	Medium-high	Summaries and decision support from approved school information; requires careful data permissions and validation.
5	Student Study Coach	Students	High	Guided explanations and practice without doing assessed work for students; requires age, safeguarding and pedagogy controls.
6	Academic Writing Coach	Students	High	Supports structure, argument, clarity and reflection while maintaining transparent authorship and assessment rules.
7	HR / Staff Assistant	Staff	High	Policy and process support; sensitive HR data should be tightly excluded or permissioned unless governance is mature.
8	Admissions Assistant	Admissions	Medium-high	Routine information and workflow support; final admissions judgements remain human.

5 People, Pedagogy and Capability

The project succeeds only if staff confidence, professional judgement and educational design develop faster than tool adoption. Staff development should therefore be practical, differentiated and linked to real work rather than generic “prompt training”.

Capability stage	Expected capability	Audience
Level 1 - Awareness	Understand generative AI, limitations, hallucinations, bias, privacy and Trident rules.	All staff
Level 2 - Confidence	Use approved AI safely for routine professional tasks and verify outputs.	All staff
Level 3 - Pedagogical integration	Redesign learning, questioning, feedback and assessment around purposeful AI use.	Teaching staff
Level 4 - Innovation	Design repeatable workflows, agents, shared resources and evaluation approaches.	AI Champions / selected leaders

Professional learning model

- Short whole-staff foundations followed by role-specific workshops and department application.
- “Bring a real task” sessions: teachers use AI on an actual lesson, assessment, report, data set or resource and compare quality and time saved.
- Department exemplars: each department identifies high-value and high-risk uses relevant to its subject.
- Peer observation and sharing: AI Champions collect strong examples, examples of where AI has not worked well, and real-life situations where the appropriate use of AI is unclear and requires professional judgement.
- Minimum professional standard: staff must be able to protect confidential data, verify AI outputs and explain when AI use is inappropriate.

6 Student AI Literacy, Academic Integrity and Assessment

Student access to AI must be paired with explicit instruction. The goal is not merely competent tool use; it is disciplined judgement. Students should learn to ask, analyse, verify, improve and create - and to know when independent effort is educationally necessary.

Capability	Student standard
ASK	Frame a worthwhile question; provide relevant context; recognise when AI is or is not the right tool.
ANALYSE	Interrogate the response; identify assumptions, gaps, weak reasoning and bias.
VERIFY	Check claims against trusted sources, course knowledge, calculations, evidence or teacher guidance.
IMPROVE	Challenge, refine, compare alternatives and use feedback to deepen thinking.
CREATE	Produce an original, accountable output that reflects the student's own understanding and voice.

Four-level assessment use framework

Mode	Meaning	Examples
AI prohibited	Independent knowledge/skill must be demonstrated.	Closed assessments, selected drafts, oral/practical checkpoints, foundational skill tasks.
AI limited	Specific AI functions allowed; boundaries stated.	Brainstorming allowed but not drafting; translation or grammar assistance within defined limits.
AI supported	AI may support parts of the process with disclosure.	Research support, feedback, revision, coding assistance, drafting with process evidence.
AI integrated	Effective AI collaboration is itself part of the assessed learning.	Evaluate prompts/outputs, compare models, critique bias, build solutions, document iterative human-AI process.

Departments should state the permitted mode on substantial assessments and require appropriate disclosure. Authenticity should be supported through oral questioning, process evidence, in-class checkpoints, practical demonstration and teacher knowledge of the student - not solely through AI-detection scores.

7 Implementation Roadmap 2026-2029

Phase	Aug-Dec 2026	Jan-Jun 2027	Aug 2027-Jun 2028	Aug 2028-Jun 2029
Strategic intent	FOUNDATION	PILOT & BUILD	INTEGRATE	SCALE & EMBED
Primary question	Are we safe, clear and ready?	What creates measurable value?	How do we make successful practice normal?	How do we sustain and improve the model?
Board gate	Approve direction, governance and pilot envelope	Review pilot evidence; authorise scale	Review impact, risks and capability	Review strategic outcomes and next-cycle investment

Phase 1 - Establish and Educate | August-December 2026

Purpose: establish governance, safe boundaries, baseline capability and a small number of controlled staff-facing pilots. The emphasis is on clarity and confidence, not school-wide deployment.

- Approve governance, policy and data-handling rules.
- Audit current staff/student AI use, licensing, workflows and risk exposure.
- Set staff baseline capability and deliver foundations training.
- Select 2-3 early pilots: preferably a policy/knowledge assistant, a teacher planning/curriculum use case and one leadership or assessment workflow.
- Agree baseline measures before pilots begin.
- Communicate clearly with staff, students and parents about purpose, boundaries and phased implementation.

Phase 2 - Pilot and Build | January-June 2027

Purpose: test high-value use cases, collect evidence, improve prompts/workflows and build local expertise. Pilots should be deliberately small enough to stop or redesign.

- Run a small number of clearly defined AI pilots across teaching and learning, student support, leadership and administration. These may include teacher support tools, student study support, administrative agents and leadership decision-support tools. Each pilot should have a specific educational or operational purpose, a named lead, agreed success measures, appropriate safeguarding and data controls, and a fixed review point. The aim is to test value in a controlled way, learn from staff and student experience, identify unintended consequences, and only scale those approaches that demonstrably improve practice, efficiency or decision-making.
- Develop the first Trident knowledge base and reusable AI resources.
- Pilot student AI literacy modules and assessment-use labelling in selected year groups/subjects.
- Measure pedagogical quality, teacher professional confidence, student learning indicators, user experience, time saved, output quality and incidents.
- Present a scale / redesign / stop recommendation for each pilot to the Steering Group and Board.

Phase 3 - Integrate | August 2027-June 2028

Purpose: make successful practices part of normal school systems and curriculum while maintaining central standards. Expand only where evidence is positive and capability is sufficient.

- Embed AI literacy and academic-integrity expectations across curriculum and year groups.
- Scale teacher-facing capabilities with department-specific guidance and exemplars.
- Extend approved agents where security and value are demonstrated.
- Integrate AI expectations into induction, professional development, curriculum review and assessment quality assurance.
- Develop leadership reporting and operational automation in controlled areas.

Phase 4 - AI-enabled Trident | August 2028-June 2029

Purpose: move from projects to a mature operating model in which AI is an unobtrusive support layer, with strong human oversight, evidence, governance and continuous improvement.

- Review portfolio value, remove redundant tools and consolidate around effective platforms.
- Mature the Trident Way knowledge/agent architecture and role-based assistants.
- Track longitudinal effect on workload, learning, student agency, organisational efficiency and community confidence and trust.
- Refresh governance, assessment and curriculum in light of evolving AI capability.
- Define the 2029-2032 strategy based on evidence, external developments and Trident's distinctive model.

8 Measures of Success, Risk and Decision Gates

Outcome area	2026 baseline / evidence	Target direction by 2029	Indicative measures
Learning	Baseline samples of engagement, quality, progress and feedback practice.	Improved quality and responsiveness without reduced independence.	Student work sampling; progress data; learning walks; feedback turnaround; student surveys; oral verification.
Teaching	Staff AI confidence and workload baseline.	Increased pedagogical understanding and professional confidence; stronger lesson design, questioning, differentiation and assessment; better use of evidence about student learning; improved quality and responsiveness of feedback; more purposeful curriculum planning; and reduced avoidable workload, creating more time for high-value teaching, relationships and professional judgement.	Pulse surveys; task-time studies; teacher reflection; planning and assessment quality review; learning walks; feedback quality; adoption of AI within clearly defined, high-value workflows.
Leadership	Current reporting cycle times and information bottlenecks.	Faster, better-informed preparation and decision support.	Time-to-report; duplicate processes removed; accuracy checks; leader feedback.
Students	Initial AI literacy and integrity understanding.	Students can use, critique, verify and disclose AI appropriately.	AI literacy tasks; academic-integrity incidents; disclosure quality; student voice; oral checks.
Organisation	Current licensing, process and support baseline.	Secure, consolidated, supportable ecosystem with demonstrable value.	Cost per use case; approved-tool compliance; security/privacy incidents; support tickets; process time saved.

Risk register - strategic risks to monitor

ID	Risk	Impact	Primary mitigation	Owner
R1	Data/privacy breach	High	Restrict approved platforms; data classification; staff training; vendor review; least-privilege access; incident process.	IT/Data lead
R2	Academic dependency / reduced thinking	High	Assessment redesign; explicit AI literacy; AI-use modes; oral/process verification; teacher judgement.	Academic lead
R3	Safeguarding / harmful content	High	Age-appropriate access; filtering; reporting routes; human supervision; safeguarding review of student-facing tools.	DSL / safeguarding
R4	Inaccurate AI output used as fact	High	Verification standard; source checking; professional review; no unsupervised high-stakes decisions.	All leads
R5	Staff inequity / change fatigue	Medium	Differentiated PD; AI Champions; phased adoption; protected time; minimum standards rather than tool enthusiasm.	SLT / PD lead
R6	Tool proliferation / rising cost	Medium	Central approval; licence register; annual value review; retire low-value tools; integration preference.	IT / Business lead

ID	Risk	Impact	Primary mitigation	Owner
R7	Community concern or lack of trust	Medium	Transparent and proactive communication; clearly explain Trident's educational purpose, safeguards and boundaries for AI use; provide opportunities for parent, student and staff engagement; publish guiding principles; and maintain an accessible feedback route.	Head / Communications
R8	AI automates poor processes	Medium	Process review before automation; define outcome and owner; measure quality as well as speed.	Process owner

9 Master Implementation Matrix

This is the core working project plan. Proposed roles and timings should be confirmed by the AI Steering Group and then maintained as a live tracker.

ID	Workstream	CLEAR ACTION POINT	Deliverable / evidence	Proposed lead	TIMELINE	Success / decision criterion	Status / RAG
G1	Governance	Form the Trident AI Steering Group and confirm terms of reference, membership, authority and reporting route.	Approved ToR; named membership; meeting calendar.	Head / SLT	Aug 2026	Group constituted; decisions and risks have a single governance home.	Not started
G2		Adopt the Trident LTCES Framework - a decision framework developed by Trident College - and require it for every material AI pilot, licence or agent.	One-page approval template and decision log.	AI Steering Group	Aug-Sep 2026	100% of material pilots have documented purpose, risk and success criteria.	Not started
G3		Publish an interim AI acceptable-use and academic-integrity framework for staff and students.	Approved policy / guidance; staff and student versions.	Academic + IT + DSL	Sep 2026	Expectations understood; gaps captured for formal policy revision.	Not started
G4		Define activities that AI must never perform autonomously.	High-stakes decision exclusion list.	Head / DSL / HR	Sep 2026	Safeguarding, discipline, HR, medical and admissions boundaries explicit.	Not started
G5		Create central AI risk, incident and decision registers.	Live registers reviewed monthly.	Project manager / Steering Group	Sep-Oct 2026	All material incidents and decisions recorded with owner and follow-up.	Not started
G6		Complete an annual governance and policy refresh.	Annual AI governance report and revised policy where needed.	AI Steering Group	Jun each year 2027-29	Policy reflects practice, incidents and technology changes.	Not started
G7		Provide a termly Board AI dashboard and annual strategic review.	Board dashboard and annual review paper.	Head / Steering Group	Termly from Dec 2026	Board sees progress, risk, cost, impact and next decisions.	Not started
D1	Data & Security	Audit current AI use by staff and students, including tools, accounts, purposes and any known data exposure.	Baseline usage and risk map.	IT lead + AI Champions	Aug-Sep 2026	Priority risks and common use cases identified.	Not started
D2		Define a simple school data-classification rule for AI: public, internal, confidential, highly sensitive.	AI data-handling guide with examples.	IT/Data lead	Sep 2026	Staff can identify what may and may not be entered into each approved service.	Not started
D3		Create and maintain an approved AI tools register with licence, age, privacy, data and support information.	Approved-tools register.	IT lead	Oct 2026; ongoing	Unapproved use reduces; procurement is coordinated.	Not started
D4		Establish vendor/tool review criteria covering privacy, retention, model training, permissions, location, safeguarding and exit.	Vendor review checklist and record.	IT/Data + Business	Oct-Nov 2026	No material platform adopted without documented review.	Not started
D5		Implement role-based access and knowledge permissions for AI agents and internal knowledge sources.	Permissions architecture; test results.	IT lead	Jan-Jun 2027	Users only retrieve information appropriate to role; access tests pass.	Not started
D6		Run an annual security/privacy exercise focused on AI-related scenarios.	Scenario exercise and action report.	IT/Data + DSL	Annually from 2027	Response routes tested; corrective actions closed.	Not started
S1	Staff Capability	Baseline staff AI confidence, current practice, workload pain points and training needs.	Staff survey / interviews; baseline dataset.	PD lead / AI Champions	Aug-Sep 2026	Priority training and pilot needs are evidence-based.	Not started

ID	Workstream	CLEAR ACTION POINT	Deliverable / evidence	Proposed lead	TIMELINE	Success / decision criterion	Status / RAG
S2	Staff Capability	Deliver mandatory AI foundations for all staff: capability, hallucination, bias, privacy, verification and Trident expectations.	Training module; completion record.	AI Champions + IT	Sep-Oct 2026	At least 90% completion; post-session confidence and knowledge improve.	Not started
S3	Staff Capability	Recruit and develop a cross-school AI Champion group representing subjects and functions.	Champion cohort; role expectations; meeting cycle.	SLT	Sep 2026	Every major area has a local support/contact point.	Not started
S4	Staff Capability	Run practical role-based workshops using real Trident tasks rather than generic prompt exercises.	Workshop sequence and examples repository.	AI Champions	Oct 2026-Jun 2027	Participants can show a quality gain, time saving or improved workflow.	Not started
S5	Staff Capability	Create a shared bank of approved prompts, workflows, strong examples, examples of where AI has not worked well, real-life situations where appropriate AI use is unclear and requires professional judgement, and verification techniques.	Trident AI practice library.	AI Champions	Nov 2026-Jun 2027	Reusable resources are used and improved by departments.	Not started
S6	Staff Capability	Embed AI capability into new-staff induction and annual professional learning.	Induction module; annual PD strand.	HR / PD lead	From Aug 2027	New staff reach minimum safe-use standard quickly.	Not started
S7	Staff Capability	Introduce advanced innovation pathway for staff building repeatable workflows or agents.	Level 4 programme; showcase / review.	AI Steering Group	2027-28 onward	Innovation produces scalable, governed use cases rather than isolated experimentation.	Not started
T1	Teaching & Learning	Identify 3-5 high-value pedagogical, curriculum, assessment or avoidable-workload problems for initial testing.	Prioritised use-case backlog.	Academic lead + HODs	Sep 2026	Use cases have clear problem statement, owner and baseline.	Not started
T2	Teaching & Learning	Pilot a teacher planning/curriculum coach with selected departments.	Pilot workflow; training; evaluation report.	Academic lead + HOD pilots	Oct-Dec 2026	Improves curriculum understanding and sequencing, lesson design, questioning, differentiation, resource selection and teacher professional judgement; any preparation-time benefit is captured as an additional outcome.	Not started
T3	Teaching & Learning	Pilot an assessment coach for question design, rubrics, moderation or feedback workflows.	Pilot and moderation samples.	Assessment lead	Jan-Mar 2027	Strengthens assessment literacy, question design, moderation, feedback and interpretation of student learning; efficiency gains and failure modes are documented.	Not started
T4	Teaching & Learning	Develop subject-specific guidance on high-value, low-value and inappropriate AI use.	Department AI guidance sheets.	HODs	Jan-Jun 2027	Every subject can articulate its own boundaries and opportunities.	Not started
T5	Teaching & Learning	Integrate appropriate consideration of AI into existing curriculum review, lesson observation and learning-walk processes, ensuring that the focus remains on the quality of pedagogy, student learning and professional judgement rather than on AI use for its own sake.	Updated Quality Assurance and curriculum-review processes, including appropriate prompts for considering how AI is being used to strengthen pedagogy, curriculum delivery, assessment and student learning.	Academic SLT	Aug 2027-Jun 2028	Where AI is used, it is evaluated by its contribution to pedagogy and student learning, not novelty or frequency; professional judgement remains human.	Not started
T6	Teaching & Learning	Scale effective teacher-facing workflows and retire weak pilots.	Scale / stop decisions; rollout plans.	AI Steering Group	Aug-Dec 2027	Only pilots meeting success threshold move to wider adoption.	Not started
T7	Teaching & Learning	Build an annual evidence cycle around AI-enabled pedagogy and teaching practice.	Case studies demonstrating changes in pedagogical understanding, planning, questioning, differentiation, assessment and feedback; workload evidence; student work review.	Academic lead	2028-29	Trident can demonstrate where AI strengthens pedagogy, teaching quality and professional capability, where it reduces avoidable workload, and where it does not add sufficient value.	Not started

ID	Workstream	CLEAR ACTION POINT	Deliverable / evidence	Proposed lead	TIMELINE	Success / decision criterion	Status / RAG
ST1	Students & Assessment	Define age-appropriate student AI expectations and access by year group.	Student AI entitlement and restrictions map.	Academic + DSL + IT	Sep-Nov 2026	Access aligns to age, safeguarding and educational purpose.	Not started
ST2		Design the Trident student AI literacy curriculum around Ask-Analyse-Verify-Improve-Create.	Progression framework and lesson materials.	Academic lead / curriculum team	Oct 2026-Mar 2027	Clear progression from introductory literacy to advanced critical use.	Not started
ST3		Pilot AI literacy teaching in selected year groups / PSHE, digital literacy or subject contexts.	Pilot lessons; student assessment; feedback.	Selected teachers	Jan-Jun 2027	Students show improved verification, disclosure and critical evaluation.	Not started
ST4		Introduce the four-level assessment labelling framework: prohibited, limited, supported, integrated.	Assessment label standard and staff guidance.	Assessment lead	Jan-Mar 2027	Substantial tasks clearly state permitted AI mode.	Not started
ST5		Develop a standard student AI-use disclosure method appropriate to age and task.	Disclosure statement / process log template.	Academic lead	Mar-Jun 2027	Students can account for material AI assistance without excessive bureaucracy.	Not started
ST6		Increase authentic assessment methods where appropriate: oral defence, process evidence, in-class checkpoints, practical demonstration.	Department assessment redesign examples.	HODs	Aug 2027-Jun 2028	Confidence in authorship and understanding improves; over-reliance risk falls.	Not started
ST7		Pilot a student study coach only after governance, permissions, age and pedagogy controls pass.	Controlled pilot and impact evaluation.	Academic + IT + DSL	Earliest Aug-Dec 2027	Students receive support without shortcutting assessed thinking; safeguarding criteria met.	Not started
ST8	Students & Assessment	Develop advanced AI fluency for senior students: research, model critique, creativity, productivity, ethics and future-of-work capability.	Senior student programme / portfolio.	Academic + Careers	2028-29	Leavers can demonstrate responsible, critical and productive AI collaboration.	Not started
A1	AI Agents & Knowledge	Inventory policies, handbooks, curriculum documents and other authoritative content suitable for a Trident knowledge base.	Content inventory with owner and review date.	Operations + Academic + IT	Sep-Oct 2026	Authoritative sources identified; duplicates/outdated versions flagged.	Not started
A2		Establish document ownership, naming, version control and update rules before connecting content to agents.	Knowledge governance standard.	IT / Operations	Oct-Nov 2026	Agent answers can be traced to current approved sources.	Not started
A3		Build and pilot a staff Trident Policy / Knowledge Assistant.	Working pilot with test set and feedback log.	IT + Operations	Nov 2026-Mar 2027	High answer accuracy on approved test questions; clear escalation when uncertain.	Not started
A4		Define a common agent design standard: purpose, data, permissions, guardrails, prompt, human review, logging, owner and retirement rule.	Agent design template.	IT / Steering Group	Jan 2027	Every agent has an accountable owner and explicit boundary conditions.	Not started
A5		Develop teacher curriculum/lesson/assessment agents from shared standards rather than isolated personal bots.	Shared governed agents / workflows.	Academic + IT	2027-28	Consistency, supportability and quality exceed individual ad hoc solutions.	Not started
A6		Review the full agent portfolio annually and retire duplicative, risky or low-value agents.	Portfolio review and decisions.	AI Steering Group	Annually from Jun 2028	Smaller, higher-value, better-governed ecosystem.	Not started
L1	Leadership & Operations	Map leadership and administrative processes with high manual cognitive load or repeated information retrieval.	Opportunity map ranked by value/risk.	SLT / Operations	Oct-Nov 2026	Shortlist based on time, frequency, error risk and strategic value.	Not started
L2		Pilot one low-risk leadership workflow such as meeting synthesis, policy retrieval or report preparation.	Pilot report and time comparison.	SLT pilot owner	Jan-Mar 2027	Time saved without factual/quality deterioration.	Not started

ID	Workstream	CLEAR ACTION POINT	Deliverable / evidence	Proposed lead	TIMELINE	Success / decision criterion	Status / RAG
L3	Leadership & Operations	Define the data permitted in leadership AI analysis and the validation required before decisions.	Leadership AI data/validation protocol.	Head + IT/Data	Jan-Mar 2027	Sensitive data and automated inferences are appropriately constrained.	Not started
L4	Leadership & Operations	Develop a leadership dashboard/assistant in stages, beginning with non-sensitive approved datasets and documents.	Prototype; validation record.	IT/Data + SLT	Apr-Dec 2027	Insights are accurate, useful and reproducible; leaders understand limitations.	Not started
L5	Leadership & Operations	Pilot one low-risk administrative AI workflow in admissions, communications, policy/process retrieval, meeting administration or another routine process where the process owner can define clear boundaries. Defer sensitive HR-data use until governance and permissions are demonstrably mature.	One controlled low-risk administrative pilot and evaluation report.	Function lead + IT	Jan-Jun 2027	Process quality, timeliness or efficiency improves; data boundaries are respected; high-stakes human decisions remain protected.	Not started
L6	Leadership & Operations	Automate or simplify proven low-risk repetitive workflows and track realised benefit.	Benefits register: hours saved / steps removed / quality.	Operations / Business	2028-29	Measurable efficiency with no material increase in incidents or complaints.	Not started
C1	Community	Develop a clear communication narrative explaining why Trident is using AI, what it will protect and what it will not automate.	Parent/staff/student communication pack.	Head / Communications	Oct-Nov 2026	Community demonstrates understanding, confidence and trust in Trident's approach; concerns are captured and responded to; an accessible feedback channel is established.	Not started
C2	Community	Include AI expectations in student and parent onboarding / handbooks once policy is approved.	Updated onboarding materials.	Academic / Admissions	2027 intake onward	Expectations are clear before issues arise.	Not started
C3	Community	Run at least one parent/community AI information session focused on learning, integrity, safety and home support.	Session and FAQ.	Head / Academic lead	Jan-Jun 2027	Parent questions and concerns are captured and addressed.	Not started
C4	Community	Create a student voice mechanism to evaluate usefulness, fairness, pressure, access and unintended effects of AI.	Student pulse / focus group process.	Pastoral / Student leadership	From 2027	Student experience informs design and risk decisions.	Not started
C5	Community	Share selected Trident case studies and principles externally when evidence is mature.	External thought-leadership / school communication.	Head / Communications	2028-29	External messaging is evidence-led and reinforces Trident's educational identity.	Not started
E1	Evaluation & Value	Define baseline measures before each pilot: pedagogical or operational quality, time, learning outcome, user experience, risk and cost.	Standard pilot scorecard.	Steering Group	Sep-Oct 2026	Every pilot can be judged against pre-agreed evidence rather than enthusiasm.	Not started
E2	Evaluation & Value	Create a benefits register capturing pedagogical and quality gains, hours saved, process reductions, learning impact and qualitative evidence.	Live benefits register.	Project manager	From Nov 2026	Benefits are traceable and not double-counted.	Not started
E3	Evaluation & Value	Track total AI-related cost including licences, training, implementation and support.	Annual cost / value statement.	Business / Finance	From 2026-27	Board can see total cost of ownership and value by use case.	Not started
E4	Evaluation & Value	Set explicit scale / redesign / stop thresholds for pilots.	Decision criteria attached to pilot charter.	AI Steering Group	Before each pilot	Weak or unsafe pilots can be closed without sunk-cost pressure.	Not started
E5	Evaluation & Value	Run annual staff and student capability / experience surveys against 2026 baseline.	Trend report.	Academic / PD lead	May-Jun each year	Capability, confidence, workload and student agency can be tracked longitudinally.	Not started

ID	Workstream	CLEAR ACTION POINT	Deliverable / evidence	Proposed lead	TIMELINE	Success / decision criterion	Status / RAG
E6	Evaluation & Value	Complete a 2029 strategic evaluation and define the next AI strategy cycle.	2026-29 impact report and 2029-32 recommendations.	Head / Steering Group	Apr-Jun 2029	Board can identify measurable outcomes, unresolved risks and next investment priorities.	Not started

10 First 90 Days: Immediate Action Agenda

A focused starting sequence for August-November 2026.

When	Clear action	Required result
Weeks 1-2	Appoint Steering Group; confirm sponsor; approve this project plan as the working framework; create decision/risk/action registers.	Governance operating; no ambiguity over ownership.
Weeks 2-4	Run staff/student AI-use audit and staff capability baseline; inventory existing licences/tools; identify data-risk exposures.	Evidence baseline and priority-risk map.
Weeks 3-6	Issue interim acceptable-use, data-handling and high-stakes exclusion guidance; identify approved platforms.	Safe minimum operating standard in place.
Weeks 4-8	Deliver staff foundations training; recruit AI Champions; establish shared practice space and support route.	Minimum staff capability and local support network.
Weeks 5-9	Select 2-3 pilots using the Trident LTCES Framework (developed by Trident College) and baseline criteria; prepare pilot charters with purpose, owner, data, success metrics and stop date.	Disciplined pilot portfolio approved.
Weeks 7-12	Begin policy/knowledge assistant and teacher-facing pilot; create evaluation instruments; communicate project purpose and safeguards to parents/students.	Implementation begins with measurable, controlled use cases.
End of 90 days	Steering Group presents first progress review to SLT/Board: baseline, risks, pilots, cost envelope and decisions required.	Evidence-led next-step decision rather than expansion by momentum.

Decisions required to mobilise

- Confirm project sponsorship, Steering Group membership and operational project-management capacity.
- Confirm the institutional AI platform(s) that may be used with school-managed accounts and the boundaries for confidential data.
- Approve time for baseline audit, staff professional development and initial pilot design.
- Agree an initial pilot/licensing budget envelope rather than committing to multi-year tool proliferation.
- Agree Board reporting cadence and the first formal review point in December 2026.

11 Board Dashboard - Recommended Termly View

Dashboard domain	What the Board should see
Delivery	Actions complete / due / delayed; phase milestone confidence; major dependencies.
Learning & students	AI literacy progression; assessment changes; selected learning evidence; integrity/safeguarding trends.
Staff	Training completion; professional confidence; adoption of AI within clearly defined, high-value workflows with explicit purpose, human oversight and demonstrable benefit; pedagogical and workload/time evidence.
Technology & data	Approved tools; agent portfolio; security/privacy incidents; access or data issues.
Value	Licence/support spend; hours/processes saved; quality gains; pilots scaled/stopped.
Risk	Top 5 risks, movement since last report, incidents and mitigation status.
Decisions required	Items requiring Board endorsement, investment, risk appetite or strategic direction.

Meaningful adoption: We will measure meaningful adoption by identifying where AI is being used consistently within clearly defined teaching, learning, leadership and administrative workflows - with an explicit purpose, human oversight and demonstrable benefit - rather than simply measuring frequency of AI use.

BOARD/ TCC TEST

The Board/TCC should be able to see not only what Trident has deployed, but what has improved, what has been stopped, what risks have emerged and whether human capability is being strengthened.

12 Project Controls and Templates

Minimum pilot charter

Field	Required content
Problem	What specific educational or organisational problem are we solving?
Users	Who will use it, and who might be affected?
Current baseline	How is the task done now? What does it cost in time, quality or friction?
AI intervention	What exactly will AI do - and what will it not do?
Data & privacy	What information enters the system? What is prohibited? What permissions apply?
Human oversight	Who reviews output and retains accountability?

Field	Required content
Trident LTCES Framework (developed by Trident College)	Learning, Teachers, Community, Ethical, Sustainable - pass / concern / redesign.
Success measures	What evidence would justify scale? Include quality, time, learning, experience, risk and cost.
Pilot window	Start date, stop/review date and intended participant group.
Decision	Scale / redesign / stop, with evidence and accountable approver.

Recommended project registers

- Action register: action ID, owner, due date, status, blockers and next step.
- Risk and incident register: likelihood, impact, mitigation, owner, trend and closure evidence.
- AI tools register: platform, owner, users, purpose, cost, data class, vendor review, renewal date and retirement decision.
- Agent register: purpose, knowledge sources, permissions, guardrails, test set, owner, version and review date.
- Benefits register: baseline, realised time/quality/learning benefit, evidence source and confidence level.
- Decision log: major approvals, conditions, rationale and review date.

13 End-State: What “AI-Enabled Trident” Should Mean by 2029

By 2029, success should not look like a school saturated with visible AI products. It should look like a school in which useful AI capability has become a secure, governed and largely unobtrusive layer underneath excellent human practice.

Area	2029 end-state
Students	Can use AI critically and ethically, verify information, disclose assistance, protect their own thinking and demonstrate authentic understanding.
Teachers	Have increased pedagogical understanding and professional confidence, with reliable AI support for selected high-value work that strengthens planning, assessment and feedback while retaining curriculum authority, judgement, relationships and subject expertise.
Leaders	Can retrieve and synthesise approved information more efficiently and have stronger decision support without delegating accountability to algorithms.
School systems	Use a smaller number of well-governed tools and agents, with clear ownership, permissions, data standards, evidence and retirement rules.
Community	Understands why Trident uses AI, what the school protects, and how responsible AI use supports rather than diminishes a holistic education.
Board	Can see evidence of educational value, workforce capability, organisational benefit, cost control and responsible risk management.

THE AMBITION

We do not want to be the school that uses the most AI. We want to be the school that uses AI most intelligently - to give our students and our people more time, more capability and more opportunity to be human.

Appendix A Milestone Map

Milestone window	Expected position
Aug-Sep 2026	Governance active; baseline audit launched; interim rules agreed.
Oct-Nov 2026	Staff foundations complete; champions active; approved-tool register live; first pilots begin.
Dec 2026	First Board dashboard; pilot baseline and early evidence reviewed.
Jan-Mar 2027	Assessment framework and literacy pilots; policy/knowledge assistant, assessment and leadership pilots underway; one low-risk administrative AI workflow begins.
Apr-Jun 2027	Pilot evaluation; scale/redesign/stop decisions; parent/community learning session; annual governance refresh.
Aug-Dec 2027	Successful teacher workflows scale; AI literacy and assessment labelling expand; controlled student-facing pilot may begin.
Jan-Jun 2028	AI integrated into Quality Assurance, induction, curriculum review and selected operational workflows; annual portfolio review.
Aug-Dec 2028	Mature role-based agent portfolio; greater operational integration; evidence consolidation.
Jan-Jun 2029	Longitudinal impact review; portfolio optimisation; 2029-32 strategy recommendations presented to Board.